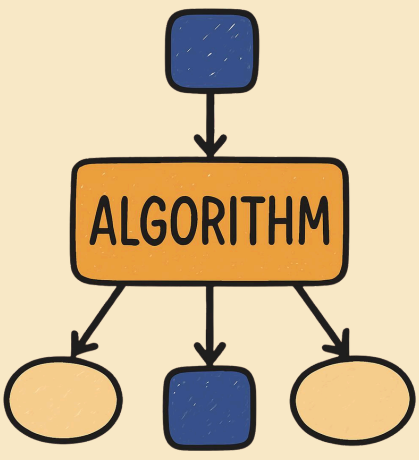
DIGITAL LITERACY AWARENESS

Digital literacy is no longer just a technical skill; it is a survival strategy. In 2026, it requires balancing a professional "online brand" against performative clout while navigating the blurry line between collaboration and academic dishonesty. As cyber threats shift from hacking software to hacking human psychology, true literacy means having the maturity to manage a permanent digital footprint that the internet never forgets.

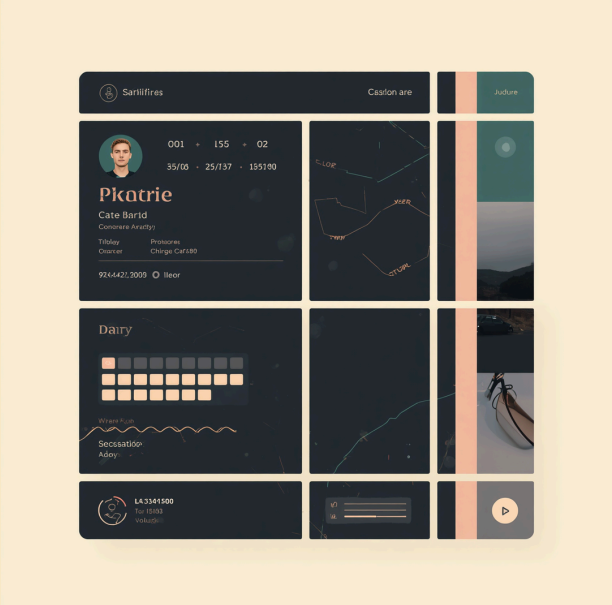


WHAT DIGITAL LITERACY IS

- UNDERSTANDING TECHNOLOGY: More than just coding or using a computer.
- CRITICAL THINKING: Evaluating information sources and spotting bias.
- ETHICAL ENGAGEMENT: Understanding digital permanence & online responsibility.

SAFE INTERNET PRACTICES

- STRONG PASSWORDS: Unique, complex, and updated regularly.
- 2-FACTOR AUTHENTICATION (2FA): An essential extra layer of security.
- SPOT SCAMS: Recognizing phishing emails & fake opportunities (e.g., 'Action Required').
- DEFEND YOUR IDENTITY: Protect sensitive information and manage cookies.

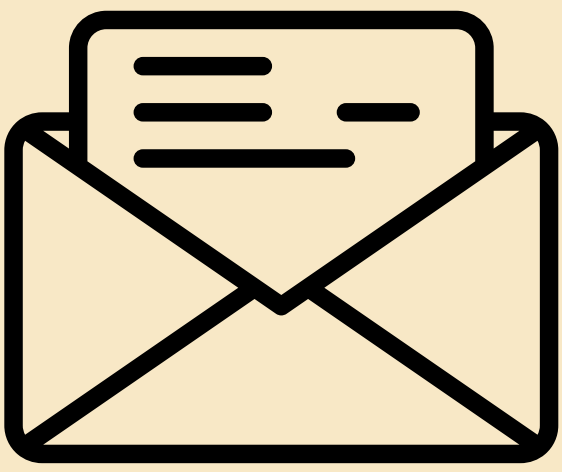


PROFESSIONAL ONLINE PRESENCE

- CURATED DIGITAL BRAND: High-quality content that showcases skills (LinkedIn, GitHub).
- AUTHENTICITY VS. PERFORMANCE: Focusing on genuine competence over shallow 'clout.'
- CREDIBILITY MATTERS: Your digital communication style reflects your attention to detail.

USEFUL DIGITAL TOOLS FOR STUDENTS

- Organization: Notion (notes/databases) & Zotero (citations).
- Technical: Overleaf (LaTeX reports) & WolframAlpha (math/data).
- Focus: Forest (study timer) & Cold Turkey (site blocker).
- Teamwork: GitHub (version control) & Miro (whiteboarding).



EMAIL ETIQUETTE

- Subject Line: Be specific (e.g., Query: Unit 2 - [Name]).
- Salutation: Use Dear Professor [Name] or Hello [Name].
- The Ask: State your request clearly in 1–2 sentences.
- Sign-off: End with Best regards or Sincerely.
- Protocol: No emojis or slang; always proofread for typos.